



Ruchika Batra
General Manager,
Corporate
Communications, Samsung
India

“We provide a single toll-free number that caters to the entire country. Customers can seek support for consumer electronics, home appliances, IT and telecom-related queries. We have a dedicated team that answers calls routed to our call centre.

“The queries are varied and deal with installations, technical issues, product features, services or demonstration requests. Basically, customer calls are divided into three tiers—the first handles queries related to product features and general inquiries; the second comprises technicians who handle queries that could not be answered by the first tier, and finally, the third comprises managerial level individuals who may handle queries that are not resolved by the first two tiers.

“We believe in servicing customers at all times. Every year, we conduct an annual free service camp where customers can come and seek support. It is during this time that our call centre receives the maximum number of calls.”

THE WAY TO BE



M Vinayagamurthy
Country Manager,
Consumer Support,
Hewlett Packard

“Yes, at HP, we do have a toll-free number for customers. There are different phone numbers for different business segments, such as, pre- and post-sales support for the consumer, and commercial and enterprise customers. Pre-sales queries are largely related to price, specifications, availability, taxes and warranty. Post-sales queries are about product usage. But the number is bound by timings. For instance, the toll-free number for consumers is six days a week from 9 am to 9 pm, but callers can reach the toll-free number for the commercial call centre five days a week from 9 am to 5 pm, in accordance with the timings of corporate customers.

“Some calls are routed to the call centre while others are handled by professionals. Our call centre executives are well-trained and undergo rigorous training on product, technical specifications and other details. They are also constantly updated on the new models we introduce.

“It’s beneficial for businesses to have toll-free numbers—it’s certainly the fastest way a customer can reach HP. The caller doesn’t pay for the call. Moreover, it’s cost-effective for us, as we can handle a large volume of queries efficiently. Toll-free numbers can offer instant solutions to issues.”



Alok Bharadwaj
VP, Canon India Private
Limited

“We have set up a national call centre facility to provide pre- and post-sales support to customers. It’s extremely convenient for customers as they can call that number from any part of the country and need to only pay local call charges. The call centre is a single point of contact for Canon’s customers and plays a critical role in driving business growth and customer satisfaction.

“We respond to each and every customer query without exception. We also have a feedback mechanism wherein we try to see how satisfactorily the customer’s problem was resolved.

“Customer Delight is Canon’s theme for this year. For instance, for our copier customers we have launched 24 x 7 service facility for service support. This type of facility is well appreciated in the changing business environment where working hours differ from the conventional 9 to 5 routine.”

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